

NUS High ALUMNI NEWSLETTER

Volume 1 | August 2026

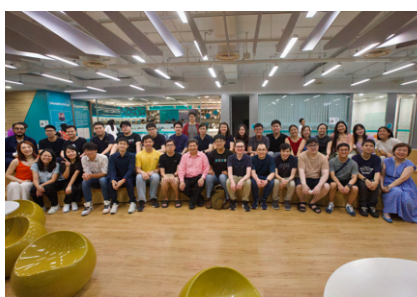
Introduction



Welcome to the inaugural edition of the NUS High Alumni Newsletter! In this newsletter, you can see highlights of events like Homecoming and Alumni Games Night, organised just for you. Stay up to date with alumni happenings by getting introduced to our Alumni Association Exco and reading about two alumni spotlights. Last but not least, meet our adorable mascot, Novus! The Alumni Newsletter is meant to help you keep connected to the school and to strengthen bonds within the alumni network. We hope you enjoy it!

Homecoming

On 1 August 2025, we held our 20th Anniversary Homecoming, welcoming home 17 alumni cohorts, our former principals and staff. Smiles and laughter were found everywhere as old friends reconnected over nostalgic memories. After the main programme, we were wowed by performances by our teachers and alumni. Thank you to all who came and helped make Homecoming a blast!



Get Involved!





EXCO Intros



Chris (CO'12)

Hey there! I'm Chris Hnin (Class of '12). Born in Myanmar, raised in Singapore and educated in the U.S. (Tufts University A17), I am a true third-culture kid who has deep roots here in Singapore. I love NUS High for everything it has done for me -

it was a place where I could truly be myself and nurture my curiosity for not just maths and science, but the world.

As our school crosses our 20th year milestone, I'm eager and passionate about bringing the alumni body together. I believe our community is a truly unique one and we have a lot more to do in terms of building connections, supporting future leaders and just giving back to our alma mater.

Professionally, I am an ex-McKinsey management consultant, a certified executive coach and, currently, I run Goji Women's and Family Physiotherapy at Lentor Modern with Cheryl Long (Class of '12).

Fun fact: NUS High community has a funny way of finding you at the most random places. When my husband (Charles Wong, Class of '12) and I moved into our home, our neighbour turned out to be a NUSHS alumni as well (Zachary Koh, Class of '19). I see our high school friends almost every week :)



Gloria (CO'12)

I graduated from NUSH in 2012, and since then I've been boomeranging back and forth between Singapore, SF Bay Area, and New York. Currently, I am back at MOE as a product design manager, building digital tools that lighten teacher admin workload, and drive holistic student development. I share the NUSH spirit with my fellow alumni who play tennis and go to bathhouses together (and welcome anyone who wants to join)! Pants high socks high NUS high!!



Shi Yi (CO'14)

Hello Alumni! I am Shi Yi from the Class of 2014. I am currently doing investigation work in the Singapore Police Force. You might see me on the news sometimes! I enjoy being outdoors and I am trying to be proficient at new activities like skiing. I have also taken a recent interest in cooking. One day, I would like to run a school canteen stall and sell delicious food.



Mitchell (CO'10)

Hello, I'm Mitchell! I graduated from NUS High in 2010 and am honored to be part of the ExCo as we launch our very first newsletter. After spending over a decade in the SAF, I am currently navigating an exciting career transition into the automotive sector to support my family business. My professional journey has always been fueled by a passion for solving complex problems and building systems that improve both efficiency and user experience.

Outside of work, I enjoy photography, traveling with my family, and occasionally diving deep into niche hobbies that, admittedly, become brief obsessions. I truly value the lifelong connections we have built here and hope to foster a more vibrant, supportive network for all our graduates. It is always inspiring to see the diverse paths our community has taken, and I look forward to reconnecting with many of you through this network!



Wei Han (CO'12)

I'm Pang Wei Han, from the batch of 2012! Despite being deeply rooted in STEM, I've always had a strong appreciation for the arts and sports as well.

I strongly believe that alumni relations are often taken for granted, yet they remain one of the most valuable assets for both the school and its students. Friends from NUSHS will always hold a special place in my heart — we're such a close-knit and unique community, and I truly believe we can all learn from and support one another in our own quirky ways.

I'm looking forward to reconnecting with more alumni, meeting current students, and sharing my experiences from NUSH and beyond. Nerd and proud!



Zhi Cheng (CO'14)

Hi everyone! I'm Zhi Cheng, class of 2014. NUS High honestly shaped a lot of how I think, the inquisitive bug, the "figure it out" mentality, the SUPER nerdy jokes and random deep conversations with people way smarter than me. These days I'm a financial consultant working mainly with young professionals in Singapore, helping them navigate the big money moments: first paycheck, figuring out what to do with your bonus, CPF, BTO, growing a family, all the stuff nobody really teaches you in school. It's genuinely meaningful work, and I find that the analytical rigour NUS High drilled into us actually shows up a lot in how I approach planning with clients. Outside of work I stay active through dance and sport, which somehow keeps me sane. Still grateful for this community, good to be back in touch!

ALUMNI SPOTLIGHT

Sankar Ananthanarayanan (CO'12)

"I feel like a lot of scientists put in a lot of effort to hone their sciences, but they don't put in enough effort to hone their communication skills, and then you end up with a lot of really boring science."

Do you think snakes are scary? Sankar doesn't think so. Sankar is a herpetologist currently doing his PhD at NUS on reptile extinctions and reintroductions in Singapore. In 2015, he co-founded the Herpetological Society of Singapore, whose goal is to educate and bring awareness to the various species of reptiles and amphibians that contribute to the biodiversity in Singapore. His passion for education and science communication was shaped partly by his non-STEM pursuits while at NUS High. Being in the Drama Club taught him how to communicate and establish a presence, and his literature teachers helped give him the confidence to communicate well. It was this exposure to humanities that helped him gain the communication

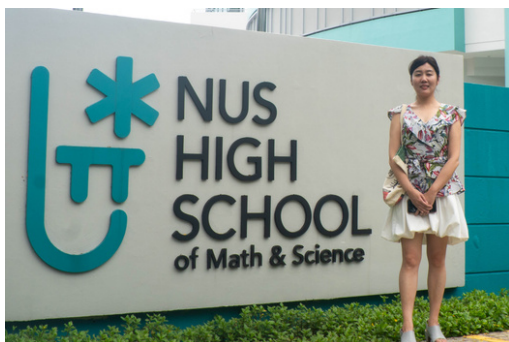


skills he has now. One of the many NUS High teachers who inspired him is Ms Fong Kit Ching, whose engaging lessons turned him from (in his words) "a very bad student" into someone good at biology. He remembers telling her that he would become a teacher one day – and true enough, he currently enjoys being a teaching assistant and hopes to continue teaching at the university level after he finishes his PhD.

Hu Jingxuan (CO'08)

"...art forms always integrate with technology. You cannot stay stagnant."

Jingxuan took a rather unorthodox path out of NUS High, getting a BFA from School of the Art Institute of Chicago and an MFA from Central Saint Martins School of Art and Design. She is currently the Associate Dean and Associate Professor of Contemporary Art at Shenzhen Technology University. NUS High has been very important in making Jingxuan the person she is today. She found role models in the Music and Art teachers at NUS High, who inspired her to pursue art even beyond the curriculum. Now, as an educator, she believes that students need a role model to look up to, and she tries to provide that for her own students. Studying at NUS



High taught her to think logically and critically, useful skills that have lent more depth and complexity to her artistic practice. She believes that it is important to be open-minded in this day and age, especially with the rise of Artificial Intelligence. Despite having a traditional upbringing in art, she embraces such new technologies, experimenting and exploring with it to translate her vision into art.

Singapore International Mathematical and Computational Challenge



The Singapore International Mathematical Challenge (SIMC) was a biennial mathematical modelling competition for senior high students inaugurated in 2008. A stronger computational element was introduced in 2022 (hence, the change in name to the Singapore International Mathematical & Computational Challenge (SIMC 2.0)). Junior High students were also included for the first time in 2024 via the Explore track.

This year, we are in the 3rd iteration of SIMC 2.0. The Explore track focused on AI Robotics learning, where students build foundational AI skills and work on real-world robotics challenges in a guided environment. The Endeavour track is a mathematical and computational modelling challenge based on real-world applications. It is reserved for the Senior High students and retains the rigour of the original SIMC.

We have also organised the SIMC 2.0 Educators Learning Festival, a platform for educators to share knowledge on Mathematics education for gifted learners, computational modelling in Mathematics, and the use of technology in Mathematics education. Beyond the academic programme, SIMC 2.0 also provided a memorable cultural exchange for our students, who had the opportunity to host overseas participants and introduce them to Singapore's rich heritage through visits to Chinatown and Little India, fostering friendships and meaningful cross-cultural connections.

More details of SIMC 2.0 can be found in the website: <https://simc2nush.org/>



ARP Mentorship



In 2023, NUS High alumnus Kendrick, currently pursuing a Master's in Physics at the University of Bordeaux in France, mentored students undertaking their Advanced Research Projects (ARP) while at DSO National Laboratories. The opportunity arose after he attended a conference where researchers from the National University of Singapore shared challenges in characterising Singapore's atmosphere for optical communications. Recognising that his team at DSO was investigating similar questions on how light propagates through Singapore's unique atmospheric conditions, Kendrick saw an opportunity for collaboration.

Through Dr Chiam and the NUS High Astronomy Club, a three-way partnership was formed between DSO, NUS and NUS High. Reflecting on the experience, Kendrick shared that "all science is collaboration", highlighting how such partnerships provide students with valuable research exposure while fostering connections between academia and industry. He also noted that successful collaborations require careful consideration of factors such as goal alignment, project scope, timelines and research objectives.



His advice to aspiring researchers? Don't be afraid to put yourself out there. Whether by approaching professors, researchers or institutions, a simple expression of interest can often be the first step towards meaningful opportunities.



Novus

Have you noticed something new around NUS High? Novus, our mascot, debuted in early 2025 during Orientation. Since then, the loveable icon has been spotted at events like the Orientation Program, Singapore Science and Engineering Fair, Speech Day, Open House, and Homecoming.

Novus was designed by our own students, with variants like chibi Novus developing over the years. The design is inspired by the white-bellied sea eagle, a bird native to Singapore. In the 1970-1980s, the banknote of the highest denomination (\$10,000) in a bird series depicted this eagle. Bionic elements have been incorporated into the design as a nod to our commitment to science and technology.

Novus' name was chosen via students' votes. The name symbolises our school's diverse accomplishments and the continual growth of our students. It ties in with our school values of excellence and wonderment, inspiring our school community to strive for our best and continue to reach for the stars.



NUSHigh Giving - \$1 Million Target Reached!

During our 20th Anniversary last year, we launched NUSHigh Giving, a fundraising initiative in support of the school's vision to nurture future-ready pioneers, humanitarians and innovators who experiment, explore and excel. We are delighted to share that our community — alumni, parents, staff, students, partners and beneficiaries — has collectively helped us reach our \$1 million target. Thank you sincerely for your generosity and support.

Donations continue to be welcome — please click on this link: <https://www.nushigh.edu.sg/give-back-to-nus-high/> for donations. As a token of appreciation, a Novus Excel Plushie will be given for donations of \$100 and above

Alumni Games Night

The Alumni Association has been hosting monthly alumni sports gatherings at the NUS High Indoor Sports Hall since January of this year. So far, we have played captain's ball, badminton, and pickleball. The Alumni Games Night is usually held on Thursday or Friday evenings, 730pm to 10pm.



Discussions about opening up the school's rooftop tennis courts for alumni tennis games are also in progress!

Stay connected with the alumni community! Join our Alumni Telegram chat for updates, activities, and announcements.



Get Involved!

